

Russell Dudek

PROCESS EXCELLENCE, AUTOMATION & OPERATING TRANSFORMATION LEADER



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Interview Thesis Brief

Candidate thesis

Scale the workflow and its assurance together. Automation should improve member value, employee flow, control evidence, and operating ownership as one system.

REAL MANDATE

Build and lead a process-automation portfolio and team that can identify the right work, select fit-for-purpose platforms, use process intelligence, embed risk and compliance, prove value against KPIs, and convert successful automations into a durable enterprise capability.

WHY NOW

- USAA's 2025 public reporting emphasizes member value, simpler digital experiences, improved claims processing, reduced paperwork, and more seamless integration across products and services.
- The role itself explicitly places risk identification, measurement, monitoring, and control inside the Process Excellence mandate.
- Public regulatory context raises the cost of automation that cannot explain ownership, evidence, monitoring, and exception handling.

OPERATING TENSIONS

Speed / assurance Reduce friction without allowing automation velocity to outrun control evidence.	Standard / variation Create enterprise discipline without flattening legitimate business differences.	Platform / process Select tools from business and process needs, not vendor gravity.
ROI / member value Connect economics to visible operating outcomes.	COE / ownership Centralize capability while keeping outcomes with process owners.	Automation / judgment Retain human authority where context materially affects the decision.

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The Automation Assurance Twin

TWO SYNCHRONIZED VIEWS

Work plane

- Member or employee need
- Process steps and handoffs
- Decision logic and exceptions
- Outcome and service effect

Assurance plane

- Named process and control owner
- Human and machine authority
- Evidence, logs, and traceability
- Monitoring, fallback, and review

PORTFOLIO DECISIONS

MODE	DECISION LOGIC	EVIDENCE BEFORE SCALE
Redesign	Exceptions and handoffs dominate.	Root causes, simplified flow, decision rights.
Assist	Judgment or member context matters.	Human authority, quality review, override learning.
Automate	Rules, inputs, exceptions, fallback are stable.	Control mapping, traceability, monitoring, recovery.
Standardize	Evidence supports reuse across comparable work.	Realized value, ownership, reuse boundary, maintenance economics.

VALUE SCORECARD

- **Member value:** friction, cycle time, repeat contact, service outcome.
- **Employee flow:** touches, rework, queue age, exception burden, retained adoption.
- **Control quality:** coverage, traceability, exception closure, monitoring.
- **Economics:** labor hours avoided, quality cost, platform and maintenance burden.
- **Learning/reuse:** repeated failure modes, change latency, reuse effort, retirement decisions.

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Proof Map

VAPE-JET - CURRENT OPERATING TRANSFORMATION

Evidence: AI-first transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.

Transfer: workflow integration, signal-to-action mechanisms, standard work, team development, and adoption inside live operations.

DUDEWORTH - AUTOMATION OPPORTUNITY AND GOVERNANCE

Evidence: frameworks for value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value; agentic workflow patterns with human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.

Transfer: portfolio selection, business cases, human authority, evidence standards, and AI/automation governance.

AMAZON - HIGH-VOLUME OPERATING MECHANISMS

Evidence: 24/7 Prime operation supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually; leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation, standard work, Lean, and Gemba.

Transfer: fact-based prioritization, leader coaching, cadence, flow visibility, and continuous improvement at scale.

COMPUNETICS - HIGH-RELIABILITY PROCESS CONTROL

Evidence: engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, high-reliability programs, quality systems, root cause, measures, and controls.

Transfer: process engineering, risk-conscious execution, technical translation, and disciplined quality systems.

Strongest objection

No claim of direct USAA RPA-platform or financial-services COE ownership. The case is adjacent operating discipline plus explicit platform/regulatory learning. A separate qualification gap remains: the record lists Six Sigma Certification but does not yet verify Green Belt level or three named projects.

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120-Day Entry and Executive Questions

DAYS 1-30

Read the system

- Portfolio, platforms, governance, risk, process intelligence.
- Stakeholder decision rights and team capability.
- Value baselines and evidence gaps.

DAYS 31-60

Align decisions

- Common intake and selection logic.
- Work/assurance paired review.
- Escalation, authority, monitoring standards.

DAYS 61-90

Prove mechanism

- Apply to bounded portfolio cases.
- Close assurance and measurement gaps.
- Coach Process Engineers in live reviews.

DAYS 91-120

Scale learning

- Reusable standards and platform guidance.
- Capability development and operating cadence.
- Quarterly value/control portfolio review.

EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

1. Where does the automation portfolio most need to change: selection, delivery, controls, value realization, or adoption?
2. Which member-friction outcomes are shared across BPM, Member Value, and business lines?
3. What decisions belong to the COE, process owners, risk partners, and platform teams?
4. How mature are process mining, task mining, and continuous monitoring?
5. Which control-evidence gaps most often delay scale?
6. What must the Process Engineers become better at over the next year?
7. How does projected automation value become validated realized value?
8. What visible change at twelve months defines success?

SOURCE BOUNDARY

Company observations use the USAA 2025 Annual Report, official newsroom mission materials, the supplied job posting, and public reporting on regulatory context. Internal-state statements are hypotheses for discovery.